ACOL · WEAK NT (12-14) - CORRECTED BIDDING FLOWCHART

Letters A-H link each opening bid to its response flowchart. Points are HCP.

OPENING BIDS

1NT 12-14 balanced → **A**

1♣/♦/♥/♠ longest suit (if equal ♥>♠>♦>♣): balanced 15-19, or unbalanced 13-22 → **B, C, D**

2NT 20-22 balanced → **E**

2♦/♥/♠ weak two: 5-10 HCP, 6-card suit → **E**

2♣ 23+ any shape, game forcing (convention) → **E**

3-level / 4-level pre-empts: 7-card / 8-card suit, 0-9 HCP → **H**

Opponents bid (overcall or double) → **F, H**

4NT once a suit is agreed, and losing trick count → **G**

A RESPONSES TO 1NT (12-14)

BALANCED hand

0-10
Pass

11
2♠ McKendrick range-ask

12
2NT invite

13+
3NT

2♠ McKendrick = 11-pt range-ask, or a weak long minor (0-10, 6+ cards). Opener 2NT = 12-13: 11 pts pass; weak hand bids 3♣/3♦ to play. Opener 3♣ = 14: 11 pts bid 3NT; weak clubs pass, weak diamonds 3♦.

Opener: 12 pass · 13-14 bid 3NT

UNBALANCED hand / holding a major

2♣ STAYMAN - 11+ with a 4-card major. Opener: **2♦** no 4-card major · **2♥** 4♥ (may hold 4♠) · **2♠** 4♠ and at most 3♥.

Suit responses: 5+ ♦ or ♥, 0-11: **2♦/♥** to play (opener passes) · 5-card major, 12+: **3♥/♠** (opener 4M with 3+, else 3NT) · 6+ major, 12+: **4♥/♠** · 6+ minor: 12-15 3NT, 16+ 5♣/♦.

Fit found (opener 2♥/2♠): 11-12 3M invite (opener 12 pass, 13-14 4M) · 13+ 4M. **No fit:** 11-12 2NT (opener 12 pass, 13-14 3NT) · 13+ 3NT. After 2♥ with 4♠ only: bid 2♠ (opener 4♠ with four, else 3NT).

Weak spades, or 5-4 in the majors, 0-11: bid 2♣, then pass if opener shows your major, otherwise bid your 5-card major (2♥/2♠) to play. Direct 2♠ is McKendrick, so weak spades go through 2♣.

B RESPONSES TO 1♣/♦/♥/♠

4+ support

4+ support: 2M 6-9 · 3M 10-12 · 4M 13-15 · with 16+ bid a new suit (forcing), support later.

After 2M: 16+ try 3M (8+ → 4M, else pass) · else pass.

After 3M: 14+ bid 4M · else pass.

No 4+ support

New suit, longest (if equal, lowest): 1-level 6+ pts · 2-level 9+ pts. Forcing, **no upper limit**: a 16+ hand starts here and plans slam.

1NT 6-9, fairly balanced.

Opener: rebid a long suit or NT (see C and D).

2NT 10-12 balanced.

Opener: 14+ bid 3NT; 13 (unbalanced) passes.

3NT 13+ balanced (with 16+, bid a new suit first). Opener passes.

C OPENER'S NT REBIDS (balanced 15-19)

After a 1-level response (6-15)

15-16 → 1NT · 17-18 → 2NT · 19 → 3NT.

Responder: after 1NT: 6-8 pass · 9 2NT (opener 15 pass, 16 3NT) · 10+ 3NT. After 2NT: 8+ 3NT, else pass. After 3NT: pass, or 4M with a 6-card suit; 14+ bid 6NT.

After a 2-level response (9-15)

15-16 → 2NT · 17-19 → 3NT.

Responder: after 2NT: 9 pass · 10+ 3NT. After 3NT: pass, or 4M with a 6-card suit; 14+ bid 6NT.

Balanced hands of 20-22 open 2NT, so a 3NT rebid shows exactly 19.

G BLACKWOOD · LOSING TRICKS

4NT once a trump suit is agreed (4NT directly over a NT bid is quantitative, not Blackwood). Replies: **5♣ 0 or 4 aces · 5♦ 1 · 5♥ 2 · 5♠ 3.**

Asker: missing two aces → sign off at 5 of the trump suit · missing one → 6 of the trump suit · all four aces → **5NT** asking kings.

Kings: 6♣ 0 or 4 · 6♦ 1 · 6♥ 2 · 6♠ 3. Asker then bids the slam.

Warning: use 4NT only when there is room to stop. If the reply already passes 5 of your trump suit, you cannot sign off at the 5-level.

LOSING TRICK COUNT (8+ card suit fit only, never NT). **24 − (opener losers + responder losers) = tricks; level = tricks − 6.** E.g. 24 − 14 = 10 tricks → 4-level. HCP→losers is approximate: count real losers when shape is unusual.

Opener		Responder	
Points	**Losers**	**Points**	**Losers**
13-14	7	0-5	10
15-17	6	6-9	9
18-19	5	10-11	8
20-22	4	12-15	7
23+	3	16+	6

D OPENER'S SUIT REBIDS (unbalanced 13-22)

Weak, 13-14: simple raise (4+ support) 1♣-1♥-2♥ · new suit below the barrier 1♣-1♥-1♠ · simple rebid of a 5+ suit 1♠-2♥-2♠.

Responder: after a raise, 13+ game, 11-12 invite · after a new suit, with 4+ support 13+ game, 11-12 invite · after a 5+ suit rebid, with 3-card support 13+ game, 11-12 invite · otherwise 10 or less pass or correct.

Strong, 15-18: double raise 1♣-1♥-3♥ · new suit above the barrier (reverse) 1♦-1♠-2♥ · jump rebid of a 6+ suit 1♠-2♥-3♠.

Responder: after a double raise, 10+ game · after a reverse, with 4+ support (or 3+ for the first suit) 10+ game, and do not pass · after a 6+ suit jump, with 2-card support 10+ game · 6-9 sign off.

Very strong, 19-22 unbalanced: jump shift 1♣-1♥-2♠, game forcing.

Responder: never pass; support partner or bid game, then investigate slam.

Barrier = the bid of 2 of the opening suit. A new suit above it is a reverse and shows extra strength. Weak twos replace the strong two, so 19-22 unbalanced hands open one of a suit.

E 2NT · WEAK TWOS (OGUST) · 2♣

2NT 20-22 balanced: 0-3 pass · 4+ points: 3NT balanced · 3♥/♠ 5-card major (opener 3NT, or 4M with 3+) · 4♥/♠ 6+ card major · 3♣ Stayman (opener 3♦ / 3♥ / 3♠; responder 4M with a fit, else 3NT).

2♦/♥/♠ weak two: 5-10 HCP, 6-card suit. Responder: pass (under 14) · 3M with 3 trumps · 4M with 4+ trumps · **2NT = OGUST ask** (14+). Opener: **3♣** minimum (5-7), poor suit · **3♦** minimum, good suit · **3♥** maximum (8-10), poor suit · **3♠** maximum, good suit · **3NT** solid AKQ suit. Good suit = two of the top three honours. Responder then signs off at 3M, bids game or 3NT.

2♣ 23+ (convention): 2♦ negative 0-7 · positive 8+: 4+ suit 2♥/♠, 5+ suit 3♣/♦, balanced 8-9 2NT or 10-12 3NT. Opener after 2♦: 5+ suit 2♥/♠ (responder 0-3 2NT; 4+ 4M with 3+ support, else 3NT) · 5+ minor 3♣/♦ · 23-24 bal 2NT (responder 0-2 pass; 3+ 3NT or 4M) · 25+ bal 3NT. After a positive: investigate slam, else game in the long suit, responder's suit or NT.

F OVERCALLS AND DOUBLES

Overcalls (their 1-suit opening): 1-level 5+ good suit, 8+ · 2-level 6+ good suit, 10+ · jump 6+ suit, 13+ · **1NT 16-18** balanced with a stopper.

Takeout double: 12+, 3+ cards in every unbid suit. Advancer bids longest suit: 0-8 lowest (1♦-X-Pass-1♠) · 9-11 jump (2♠) · 12+ game (4♠). Do not pass unless opener's partner bids.

Partner opens and RHO overcalls or doubles: bid as you would have done, ignoring it. Bid NT only with a good stopper. Lead partner's suit if defending.

Partner overcalls: raise with 3+ support (2+ after a jump overcall) · change suit only if yours is longer · NT only with a good stopper · lead partner's suit.

H PRE-EMPTS · THEIR 1NT

Pre-empts (0-9 HCP): 3♣/♦/♥/♠ = 7-card suit · 4♣/♦/♥/♠ = 8-card suit. Partner: change suit only if yours is longer; with 3-4 top honours raise to game; lead partner's suit.

Over their pre-empt (12+): 6-card suit at the 3-level (3♦/♥/♠) · 7-card suit at the 4-level · double = takeout (3+ in all unbid suits). Partner: bid longest suit, game with 12+; raise to game with 12+ and 2-card support.

Vs their 12-14 1NT: double 16+ penalty · suit overcall 10+ with a good 6+ card suit.

Our 1NT doubled: 5+ suit sign-off 2♦/♥/♠ · otherwise pass.

Opening · Response · Opener rebid · Convention · Competitive · Note

Print on A3, or scale to fit A4. Arrows show the order of the auction.